



HARSHAVARDHAN CHITALE

Chief Executive Officer,
Hero MotoCorp

MOST SUSTAINABLE COMPANY IN MANUFACTURING (AUTOMOBILES)

Hero MotoCorp's goal of being zero-waste-to-landfill was achieved in 2024, well before the target of 2025

To achieve this, the company started converting hazardous waste such as paint sludge into industrial primer

It aspires to have 100% carbon neutral operations by 2030. It has already achieved 41%

The company harvests five times more water than it consumes

480 out of its 960 dealerships have become more sustainable by using solar power



SUSTAINABILITY • PROFILE

on premises or through a tie-up with a solar power generator. The company is also working on adding battery energy storage systems. It aspires to have 100% carbon neutral operations by 2030.

Hero has 11.5 megawatt-peak of internal renewable energy power capacity through distributed captive solar installations across India. The company plans to double it over the next two to three years, says Vikram Kasbekar, Executive Director and Chief Technology Officer of Hero MotoCorp. To promote circular economy, the company has also achieved 95% recyclability for 80% of its products, adds Kasbekar.

Hero MotoCorp's sustainability efforts are not just limited to manufacturing. The automaker introduced the Green Dealers Development Programme (GDDP) to make its dealerships more sustainable by using solar power. "We want 960 dealers to operate on green electricity. We are exactly halfway there; 480 dealerships are green," Chitale says.

Apart from focusing on sustainability in manufacturing operations and retail network, the company is also betting big on electric vehicles (EVs). Even though it was a little late to the EV race, it is rapidly gaining market share. Electric two-wheeler sales nearly trebled year-on-year to 144,000 units in FY26.

In the current financial year, it has left Bhavish Aggarwal-led Ola Electric, which was an early leader, behind in sales to take the fourth spot. Hero is also the largest shareholder in Ather Energy, India's third-biggest electric two-wheeler maker. If Hero and Ather sales are combined, it adds up to the highest in the EV segment.

Hero has also forayed into electric light commercial vehicles segment by becoming the larg-

est stakeholder in Euler Motors in 2025. "Apart from investments we have made in our own brand, we are the largest shareholder in Ather Energy and Euler Motors. Last year, our market share in electric two-wheelers went up by 700 basis points. Our associate company Ather also increased its market share by 600 basis points," Chitale explains, adding that driving electrification is also part of the sustainability effort.

As it gears up to introduce electric motorcycles, Hero, along with Ather, is building a fast-charging

ABOUT 40% OF HERO MOTOCORP'S ENERGY NEEDS ARE MET VIA RENEWABLES

network, the only legacy two-wheeler maker to do so. "There are over 5,000 fast chargers that we and Ather have put up together. We have made it open and created a consortium called LEAF (Light Electric-Vehicle Acceleration Forum). We are getting other companies also to join it. There are 20 members now," says Chitale.

In an industry where each original equipment manufacturer sells vehicles with its own proprietary charging ports, Hero's efforts to bring several companies together to adopt a uniform standard could help create a sustainable charging infrastructure and give the segment a boost in the process. **BT**

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